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Psionics

Large Extension Module for Fate's Edge

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Design Philosophy: Psionics in Fate's Edge represents the disciplined mastery of the mind's hidden potentials. Unlike the chaotic forces of magic or the structured pacts of Patrons, psionic power comes from within, shaped by will and honed by practice. This internal source makes psions both powerful and vulnerable; their greatest strength is also their most dangerous weakness.

Psionics: The Mind Ascendant

In the shadowed courts and ancient ruins where Fate's Edge adventurers tread, power comes in many forms. Some bargain with Patrons, others weave elemental forces, and still others summon spirits from beyond. But there exists a subtler path, one that requires no oaths, no incantations, no material components. This is the path of Psionics, where the disciplined mind becomes the greatest tool of all.

Psionics represents the evolution of human potential, the unlocking of abilities that science claims impossible and magic struggles to explain. Where a warlock might call lightning from the sky, a psion shapes reality through the sheer force of thought. Where a mage might scry through mystical mirrors, a psion reaches across space with their consciousness alone.

But this power comes at a cost. The mind that bends reality to its will also bears the scars of that bending. Mental Strain becomes as real a threat as physical exhaustion, and the constant strain of psychic activity can fracture even the strongest psyche.

Based on the playtest experience, here are the key revisions I'd recommend for the Psionics module:

Section Core Mechanics

subsection Mental Strain Track

Your *Mental Strain* represents capacity for sustained psychic exertion.

$$\text{Mental Strain} = \text{Spirit} \text{ (minimum 2)}$$

Mark and clear Mental Strain as effects specify. When you *cannot* pay a Mental Strain cost, choose:

tem Convert the unpaid point to **+2 Fatigue** (standard system), or tem Convert the unpaid point to **+1 Harm (Stress)**.

Overflow: If you ever exceed your Mental Strain, immediately suffer **+1 Harm (Stress)** and set Mental Strain to your maximum (no further overmarking this scene).

Psionics Skill

Psionics (05) gates access to psionic Arts and sets control/efficiency. You cannot use psionic Arts without investing in this skill.

Resolution and Attribute Keys

Psionics uses **Attribute (per Art) + Psionics vs. DV**. To encourage specialisation, each Art has a *Key Attribute*. Using a nonkey attribute for that Art imposes **+1 DV** (or 1 die, GM's choice).

[c]@lll@ rule Art	Key Attribute	Alternate (with +1 DV)
Telekinesis	Spirit (force)	Wits (finesse/precision)
Telepathy	Wits	Presence (emotive broadcast)
Clairvoyance	Wits	Spirit (ritual trance)
Biofeedback	Spirit	Wits (clinical selfhack)
Astral Projection	Spirit	Wits (tethered skim)
Psychic Assault	Spirit (overwhelm)	Wits (needle, bypass)
Mind Shield	Wits (filter)	Spirit (soak)
Empathic Manipulation	Presence	Wits (cold read leverage)
Precognition	Spirit	Wits (tactical glimpses)
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DV is set by the GM (typical 25+) from scope, risk, and opposition.

Psionic Consequence System

Psionics interfaces with existing **Fatigue/Harm**. Use *Mental Strain* as the psiononly resource; use *Fatigue/Harm* for spillover consequences.

Psionic Strain (simple thresholds)

tem **Mark Fatigue when:** DV 4+ effects, engaging 3+ foes with psionics in one exchange, or maintaining an effect across 2+ scenes. tem **At 2 Fatigue:** 1 die to psionic rolls. tem **At 4 Fatigue:** choose one:tem **Surge:** One psionic use this scene ignores *Mental Strain* cost; then mark **+1 Harm** and generate **+1 SB**. tem **Efficiency:** Halve all *Mental Strain* costs for the next scene (round up). tem **Reset:** Clear all Fatigue; you cannot use psionics for one scene and mark **+1 Harm**.

Psionic Enhancements

tem[Psionic Surge (1/scene):] Spend **3 Mental Strain** to gain **+1 Effect** on a psionic action. tem[Mental Breakthrough:] At **4+ Fatigue**, you may Push a psionic effect **+1 step**; mark **+2 Harm** and generate **+2 SB**. tem[Psionic Meditation:] During any rest, recover **+1 Mental Strain** (in addition to normal recovery).

edspace4Largepesection Psionic Arts

edspace3largepesubsection Telekinesis

Key Attribute: Spirit + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (+1 DV for fine manipulation).

Action: 1 action; sustain by fiction. **Range:** *Near* (add +1 DV for *Far*).

Cost: Activate 1 Mental Strain; sustained lifts/holds 1 Mental Strain/scene.

SB: Scales with mass/force:

tem **Light (DV 23):** cups, tools, doors. *No SB.* tem **Medium (DV 4):** furniture, a person's mass, riding debris. *+1 SB on Partial/Miss.* tem **Heavy (DV 5+):** carts, statues, boulders, multitarget shoves. *+2 SB on Partial/Miss; +1 SB on Success.*

Mechanical Benefits:

tem Hurl objects as weapons (Harm by fiction and force tier). tem Shape cover: lift slabs, hold doors, create transient *Walls/Barriers*. tem Remote tasks: pull levers, pick up keys, disarm simple traps at range.

Limits/Notes:

tem Cannot *directly* crush or twist living tissue; injury is *environmental* (falling, debris, impact) at GM discretion. tem Complex, delicate work (lockpicks, surgery) typically requires the **Alternate** attribute (Wits) and adds +1 DV.

Examples: Nudge a goblet off a shelf (DV 2); rip a door from hinges (DV 4); wrench a stone pillar sideways (DV 5).

edspace3largepesubsection Telepathy

Key Attribute: Wits + Psionics **Alternate:** Presence + Psionics (+1 DV, emotive broadcast style).

Action: 1 action; sustain by fiction. **Range/Line:** *Near*, LoS (+1 DV for *Far*; +1 DV without LoS if you have a strong link).

Targets: One (add +1 DV per extra target this scene).

Design Rule: Telepathy never replaces social skills; it provides *information and setup*, not compliance.

Depths SB Choose a depth before rolling:

tem **Surface Thoughts (DV 2):** current focus. *No SB* on any result *the first time per target/scene*. Repeats: +1 DV; on Miss, +1 SB. tem **Emotional State (DV 3):** tones/urges. *+1 SB on Partial/Miss.* tem **Deep Memories (DV 5):** episodic recall. *+1 SB on Success; +2 SB on Partial/Miss.*

Outcomes

tem[Success:] Gain the info; pick *one* setup and use it by the end of your next turn this scene: tem **Angle of Approach:** +1 die to your next *Insight/Sense Motive* vs. this target. tem **Read the Room: Position** +1 on your next social roll vs. this target. tem **Pointed Question:** Ask one focused question they could presently answer; GM replies as impressions.

tem[Partial:] Blurred fragments; mark SB for depth. tem[Miss:] No useful read; mark SB for depth (if any); the target feels the brush.

Defense Counterplay

tem **Unwilling Resist:** target rolls Spirit + Resolve; on meet/beat, your read fails and you mark **+1 SB** (**+2 SB** if Deep). Margin 2+: they also intuit your intent. tem **Wards/Noise:** [WARD]s, mental static, or antipsionic training impose **+12 DV** (training at least **+1 DV**). tem **Consent:** willing targets are **DV1** and cause no SB.

NonSubstituting Benefits:

tem **Silent Speech (willing only):** short thoughts in *Near* (group size up to your **Wits**); no SB. tem **Sense Dissonance:** if you read *Surface* this scene, **+1 die** on *Wits + Insight* to vet a lie; strong hit reveals *which part* conflicts.

Notes: Reading unwilling minds in a formal social scene risks fallout; if detected, **+1 SB** even on Success.

Clairvoyance

Key Attribute: Wits + Psionics **Alternate:** Spirit + Psionics (**+1 DV**, trance method).

Action: 1 action; ritual scry may take a scene. **Range:** Scene/locale by fiction; add **+1 DV** per range band beyond *Near*.

Cost: DV 23 = **1 Mental Strain**; DV 4 = **2**; DV 5+ = **3**.

SB: *Near* none *Distant* **+1 SB** on Partial/Miss *Complex Scry* **+2 SB** on Partial/Miss; **+1 SB** on Success.

tem **Uses:** scout ahead, pierce [VEIL], track signatures, read recent traces. tem **Notes:** Covert spying on private moments generates **+1 SB**. Each extra scene sustained adds **+1 SB**.

Biofeedback

Key Attribute: Spirit + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (**+1 DV**, clinical technique).

Action: 1 action (Major work takes a focused scene).

SB: by intensity:

tem **Minor (DV 2):** stabilize, close, purge shock. *No SB*. Heal up to **Psionics** levels/day (cap 1 Harm per recipient/day). tem **Moderate (DV 3):** *+1 SB* on Partial/Miss; heal up to **Psionics** (max 2/day). tem **Major (DV 4+):** *+2 SB* on Partial/Miss; *+1 SB* on Success; heal up to **Psionics** (max 1/day); mark **+1 Fatigue**.

Perks:

tem Convert **1 Harm 1 Mental Strain** (up to **Psionics**, max 3/day). tem Brief enhancement: **+1 die** to physical rolls for a few moments.

Limits/Notes:

tem Cannot heal Harm above your **Psionics** rating; active combat imposes **Position 1**. tem Major healing requires a quiet scene. tem Healing or enhancing *others* requires consent and generates **+1 SB**.

Astral Projection

Key Attribute: Spirit + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (**+1 DV**, skim tether).

Action: 1 action to slip; travel by fiction. **Cost:** **1 Mental Strain/scene**.

SB: **+1** per band beyond *Near*; **+1** per additional scene sustained.

tem **Benefits:** pass barriers, scout hazards, converse across distance. tem **Vulnerabilities:** body is **Helpless**; nonphysical contests accrue SB; astral Harm echoes to flesh; wards add +2 DV. tem **Risk:** extended (> 3 scenes) projection courts separation (GM consequence); astral death = physical death.

edspace3large**subsection** **Psychic Assault**

Key Attribute: Spirit + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (+1 DV, needlestrike).

Action: 1 action. **Cost:** DV 23 = 1 Mental Strain; DV 4 = 2; DV 5+ = 3.

SB: always +1 (disruptive) plus DV 4 +1 and DV 5+ +2 more.

tem **Benefits:** mental Harm; bypasses physical armor; target specific faculties (sight, balance, focus) by fiction. tem **Notes:** cannot be "willingly" received; highSpirit foes may add +1 DV; use in sensitive locales may carry legal or social fallout.

edspace3large**subsection** **Mind Shield**

Key Attribute: Wits + Psionics **Alternate:** Spirit + Psionics (+1 DV, soakandground).

Action: 1 action (passive modes by fiction).

SB: Passive none; *per effect blocked* +1 SB; *Area* +2 SB and mark +2 Fatigue.

tem **Benefits:** resist intrusion/telepathy; shelter allies; create dampened zones. tem **Paradox:** protecting *others* costs 2 Mental Strain. tem **Notes:** *Area* protection covers all within *Near* (friends and foes); cannot be maintained while unconscious.

edspace3large**subsection** **Empathic Manipulation**

Key Attribute: Presence + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (+1 DV, coldread leverage).

Action: 1 action; sustain by fiction.

SB: by intensity:

tem **Subtle (DV 23):** nudge mood, steady hands. *No SB.* tem **Moderate (DV 4):** calm rage, spark courage. *+1 SB on Partial/Miss.* tem **Strong (DV 5+):** sway a crowd's tenor. *+2 SB on Partial/Miss; +1 SB on Success.*

Benefits: improve social **Position** +1; pacify beasts; inspire/demoralize groups.

Risks/Notes: You *feel* what you project; same target not more than once per scene; attempts that oppose core values are +2 DV; affecting a crowd always generates +1 SB.

edspace3large**subsection** **Precognition**

Key Attribute: Spirit + Psionics **Alternate:** Wits + Psionics (+1 DV, tactical glimpse).

Action: 1 action; deeper visions may take a scene.

Cost: DV 23 = 1 Mental Strain; DV 4 = 2; DV 5+ = 3.

SB (inherent): Minor +1 Major (DV 4) +2 Detailed (DV 5+) +3.

tem **Benefits:** advantage on future rolls (scope by GM), avoid named dangers, compare probable branches. tem **Paradox Future Fixation:** until Downtime (or a defiant choice), lose 1 **Boon/session**; actions that resist the shown path may be **Desperate** by GM call. tem **Notes:** No "pure randomness" predictions (e.g., dice, lots) without +3 DV; visions of death/calamity add +1 SB.

Large Psionic Costs

Base Costs

Activation: 1 Mental Strain **Maintenance:** 1 Mental Strain per Scene/Significant Time **Skill Requirement:** Must invest XP in Psionics skill

Revised Note: Maintenance costs can be reduced by 1 through successful Wits + Psionics (DV 3) test, but failure generates 1 SB.

Large Psionic Talents

Minor Talents (24 XP)

Mental Fortress (3 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 2+, Spirit 3+

Effect: +1 die to resist psychic effects; once per scene, convert incoming psychic Harm to Fatigue

Thought Thief (4 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 2+, Wits 3+, Telepathy

Effect: When reading surface thoughts, gain +1 die; once per scene, detect lies automatically

Psychic Reservoir (4 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 2+, Spirit 2+

Effect: Increase Mental Strain track by +2; recover 1 additional Mental Strain during rest

Revised Note: All Minor Talents now have a prerequisite of at least 1 other psionic talent, encouraging specialization.

Major Talents (68 XP)

Telekinetic Mastery (7 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 3+, Spirit 3+, Telekinesis

Effect: +1 die to Telekinesis attacks; can lift objects one category heavier without increasing DV

Mind Walker (8 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 3+, Wits 3+, Astral Projection

Effect: Astral Projection requires no concentration; move at normal speed in astral form; reduce projection cost to 1/2 Mental Strain (round up)

Psychic Vampire (8 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 3+, Spirit 3+, Psychic Assault

Effect: When dealing psychic Harm, heal 1 Mental Strain; once per scene, drain 1 Mental Strain from target (requires successful Psychic Assault)

Prestige Talents (12+ XP)

Master of Minds (12 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 4+, Wits 4+, Telepathy, Empathic Manipulation

Effect: +2 dice to all telepathic effects; can communicate with entire group simultaneously; once per scene, impose emotional state on group (DV 4, mark 2 Fatigue)

Mind Over Body (12 XP)

Requirements: Psionics 4+, Spirit 4+, Tier III+

Effect: Your Mental Strain track becomes **Spirit** + **Wits** (*min* 6, *cap* 12). Once per scene, when

you would suffer Mental Strain *overflow*, you may instead convert each overflow point into **+1 Fatigue** (standard track), with no peruse limit.

Paradox: Mind eclipses flesh. When reduced to 0 Harm, you may remain conscious at **Helpless** until your next turn; then mark **+2 Fatigue** and **+1 SB**.

Reality Bender

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Type Major Talent (15 XP)

Requirements Psionics 5+, Spirit 4+, Telekinesis, Psychic Assault, Mind Shield.

Test *Wits + Psionics* vs. **DV** (per option below).

Effect Once per session, reshape local reality within *Near* range. Choose one:

tem **Minor Alteration (DV 3)**: Change one obvious physical property (color, temperature, texture, sound) of a target within *Close* range, or create a simple illusory effect. *Lasts for the scene*. tem **Moderate Alteration (DV 4)**: Alter the structural properties of a *Medium* or smaller object (e.g., make glass flexible, metal brittle, water viscous) for *one exchange*, or create a complex illusion that includes movement and sound. tem **Major Alteration (DV 5)**: Temporarily defy a basic law of physics within *Close* range for *one exchange* (e.g., reverse gravity in a small area, stop time for a single object, make fire cold).

Costs Mark **1 Harm** and **1 Fatigue**; generate **1 SB**.

Limitations

tem Cannot create matter from nothing; you must transform or rephase existing phenomena. tem Cannot directly harm creatures (no direct damage; secondary environmental effects at the GM's discretion). tem Cannot duplicate other magic paths' signature effects exactly (adjacent expressions at the GM's discretion). tem Cannot affect unwilling targets' minds or souls.

Examples Reverse gravity in a small area; make stone flow like water; create a bridge of force; turn sound to color; make shadows solid.

Revised Note: Reality Bender now generates additional SB based on alteration severity: Minor (+1 SB), Moderate (+2 SB), Major (+3 SB). Use in populated areas generates additional 1 SB.

AntiPsionic Effects

Psionic characters are vulnerable to specific countermeasures that use existing mechanics:

Psionic Dampening [WARD]

DV = Psionics skill; Hit: impose 1 die to psionic rolls; Partial: 1 Effect

Mental Null Zone

Area effect that prevents psionic use; resisted by Spirit + Psionics

Psychic Disruption [BANISH]

Target a psionic effect; DV by fiction; Hit: end effect and mark 1 Fatigue

AntiPsionic Training

Some NPCs get +1 die against psionic effects due to specialized training

Revised Note: Antipsionic effects are more common in areas with strong magical or technological presence. Professional investigators and security personnel often have basic antipsionic training.

Balance Adjustments Summary

Telepathy

- tem Limited to once per target per scene for surface thoughts
- tem Increased DV for invasive effects (35)
- tem Unwilling targets get +2 DV bonus
- tem Social consequences for obvious use
- tem Legal implications in civilized areas

Biofeedback

- tem Daily limits on healing (13 conversions per day based on severity)
- tem Major healing limited to 1 per day and marks Fatigue
- tem Requires concentration for serious healing
- tem Cannot be used freely in combat
- tem Consent required for use on others

Psychic Fatigue

- tem Reset causes 1 Harm
- tem Surge now costs 3 Mental Strain instead of free
- tem Surge generates additional SB
- tem Integrates with existing Fatigue system

General

- tem Integrated with existing Fatigue/Harm system
- tem Uses Story Beats for consequences
- tem Added psionicspecific Talents for advancement
- tem Antipsionic effects use existing tag system
- tem Maintains parity with other magic paths
- tem Clear talent prerequisite chains
- tem Scaled Fatigue costs for arts
- tem Flexible maintenance costs
- tem Legal and social consequences

Additional Psionic Complications

Social Integration Issues

Psionic characters may face prejudice or fear from nonpsionic individuals. In some cultures, psionic abilities are viewed with suspicion or regulated by law.

Mental Scars

Intense psionic use can leave lasting psychological effects. Characters may develop phobias, compulsions, or other mental conditions related to their abilities.

Psionic Signatures

Powerful psionic use can leave detectable traces that skilled investigators or other psions can track. This creates opportunities for pursuit or identification.

Reality Bleed

Extensive use of realityaltering abilities may cause minor inconsistencies in the local fabric of reality, creating unpredictable effects that generate Story Beats.

Psionic Investigation Procedures

Evidence Handling

Psionic evidence requires special handling and verification. Mental impressions must be corroborated with physical evidence in most legal systems.

Chain of Custody

Just as physical evidence requires careful handling, mental evidence must maintain "psychic chain of custody" through proper documentation and witness verification.

CrossCultural Considerations

Different cultures have varying attitudes toward psionic investigation techniques, affecting their admissibility and effectiveness in different jurisdictions.

Section Cultural Faces of the Silent Art

Not all peoples fear the psion equally, but none trust them fully.

Subsection Aeler The Deep Accountants

In Aeler, psionics is treated as **infrastructure**a utility to be maintained, measured, and contained. They assign psions to the Deep Vaults, where their "breathdebts" can be monitored. Each Mental Strain point is counted in *bellrings*a psion carries a bell on a leather cord, and when it rings three times too fast, a Corrector arrives to audit the ledger.

They practice **Breath Accounting**, converting mental strain into measured respiration. Their psions specialize in *Structural Sense*feeling the stress points in stoneand *Resonance Mapping*, sensing the health of the Underways through mental connection.

Subsection Lethai The Context Keepers

For the Lethai, telepathy is not merely reading thoughts; it requires **context keys**the proper season, relationship, and place. Without these, a Lethai psion reads only static. Their minds are saturated with memory and social webbing, making them difficult to read (psions who try often leave mad), but also requiring them to navigate complex ritual before mental contact.

They mark their psions with **MindGifts**resinous tattoos that serve as mental anchors. The Spider's Patience grants concentration; the Serpent's Breath detects deception. A Lethai psion is less a spy and more a *living archive*, but take them from their context and they are deafened.

edspace3largebesection Ykrul The Weather Readers

The orcs of the steppe do not see the future in tea leaves. They see it in the **Kon'reh** the sacred geometry of probability. Their psions are not called seers but *Riders of the Flow*. They read the shape of the future as a cavalryman reads the shape of the land: tactical, immediate, and bound to the weather.

Storm conditions enhance their telepathic range but increase Mental Strain costs. Clear weather allows precise precognitive readings. They specialize in *Herd Sense* feeling the emotional state of a clan and *Banner Communication*, longdistance mental coordination between scattered riders.

edspace3largebesection Vilakari The Information Brokers

In the free ports, psionics is commerce. The Vilakari have developed **Thought Markets**, where memory and information are traded like grain. Their psions are *Surface Readers*, adept at detecting deception in mercantile negotiations, and *Memory Traders*, who temporarily share specific recollections for coin.

But their gift is also their vulnerability. A Vilakari psion in a crowded market is overwhelmed by the noise of surface thoughts. They require specialized training to filter the signal from the cacophony, and many fall to addiction craving the rush of other minds, burning out their own Mental Strain in weeks rather than years.

edspace4Largebesection The Silent Orders Fragments of a Scattered Tradition

No one knows where psionics came from. The Thepyrgos Synod has a standing bounty for any evidence dated to the Great Silence. The bounty has never been claimed. What follows are whispers collected by the Grey Wanderer from a dozen dusty archives and one very expensive bottle of brandy.

edspace3largeThe Scholarly Debate As Reported by the Grey Wanderer

"The Silence is not an event. It is a lacuna. A gap in the record that has been filled with too many theories and not enough evidence."

Keeper Lian, Lethaithora, from a lecture at the University of Thepyrgos

The scholars argue. They always argue.

tem[The Withdrawal (Lethaithora tradition).] Some say the ancient psions did not fall. They chose to be silent. They learned that consciousness without discipline attracts something from the spaces between thoughts. The Silence was a quarantine, not a catastrophe. (The Aeler dismiss this as "elves romanticizing their own amnesia.") tem[The Broken Frequency (Aeler ventpriors).] Others point to resonance. You cannot "choose" to stop breathing, they say. Something struck the harmonic balance of the mind. A weapon? A natural collapse? The deep vaults still ring with a frequency that does not decay. The Silence is not silence. It is *interference*. (The Lethaithora note that the Aeler have never produced a single shard of this supposed "weapon.") tem[The Forgotten Patron (anonymous Invoker of The Witness).] A third camp whispers of a patron whose domain is *forgetting*. Not Ikashashe sleeps. Not the Ninthit omits. This one *erases*. The ancient psions got too close to its true name. The Silence is the sound of that name being spoken once, then never again. (The Synod has classified this theory as "speculative and possibly heretical.") tem[The Empty Circle (Kuvani oral tradition, transcribed by an Aelinnel scribe).] The wanderers of the eastern steppe say: "They did not die. They walked into the Empty Circle and kept walking. The Circle is not a hole. It is a

door. They are still walking. When they return, the Silence will end." (The Empty Circle is real. It nullifies all psionics. No one has ever walked out of its center.) tem[The Simple Answer (skeptical Thepyrgos clerk).] Perhaps they simply exhausted themselves. They had no patrons, no codices, no symbols. Their power was purely internal. Internal things fail from internal causes. They forgot how to be what they were. (The Grey Wanderer notes that this explanation is the least satisfying and therefore the most likely to be true.)

No one knows. The Silence remains silent.

edspace3largeThe Orders That Remain

Whatever caused the Silence, it did not destroy everything. Scattered fragments survive not as an empire, but as small, secretive **orders** of monks who keep old disciplines alive. They are not wizards. They are *meditants*. They do not bargain with Patrons. They bargain with themselves.

Three such orders are known to the Grey Wanderer. There may be more.

sectionThe Order of the Unstruck Bell (Aelerian Deep Vaults)

These monks dwell in sealed galleries beneath the oldest Aeler holds. The Aeler tolerate them because they maintain "quiet zones" where stonepress is less aggressive. They use *nullbells* bronze bells that ring only in the mind.

Player Benefits (Unstruck Bell Monk):

tem **NullBell Bond:** You carry a small bronze bell that only you can hear. It counts as a *String* (once per session, ring it to gain +1 Position on a single Mind Shield or Telepathy roll).

tem **Resonant Exhale (Technique):** Once per scene, reduce your Mental Strain by 1 (to a minimum of 0). The GM immediately gains 1 Story Beat, which they may spend on a complication tied to sound, vibration, or a distant chime.

tem **GalleryBound:** You are comfortable in enclosed stone spaces. You ignore the first level of environmental penalty from underground or confined areas when using psionic Arts.

sectionThe Order of the Empty Circle (Violet Steppe)

These monks live in tents around the Empty Circle a depression in the steppe where no psionics work. They enter the Circle only to meditate in absolute silence. They believe the Silence was a *lesson*, not a wound.

Player Benefits (Empty Circle Monk):

tem **CircleTrained:** Once per session, when you would generate a Story Beat from Mental Strain on a nonpsionic roll, you may cancel that SB by marking 1 Fatigue (the strain of enforced stillness).

tem **Still Mind (Technique):** For the duration of a scene, you may choose to operate at a reduced capacity. While active, any nonpsionic action you take generates 1 fewer SB from Mental Strain (minimum 0), but you cannot use any psionic Art with a Tier higher than I (i.e., only minor effects, DV 23). This technique requires a free action to activate and deactivate.

tem **Herd Sense:** You gain +1 die to detect emotional states (anger, fear, calm) in any creature within Near range. This is a passive ability.

sectionThe Order of the Shared Breath (Eastern Isles)

These monks practice *paired meditation* two or more psions sharing Mental Strain across a Circle. They believe that debt is not individual but *communal*.

Player Benefits (Shared Breath Monk):

tem **Circle Bond:** You may form a mental link (the "Circle") with up to three willing allies (they need not be psions, but only psions can share Mental Strain). The link lasts for one scene

and requires a free action to initiate. tem **Shared Burden (Technique):** When you generate Mental Strain, you may transfer any amount of it (up to your Spirit) to another member of your Circle. That member must be within Near range and willing. The GM gains 1 Story Beat each time you use this technique. tem **Circle's Breath:** While linked, you and your Circle members gain +1 die to all psionic rolls, but if one member fails a Resolve test to resist fear or mental intrusion, all members test at +1 DV.

Note: These orders are not factions in the usual sense. They have no grand agenda. They simply survive, train, and occasionally produce a wanderer who walks the roads with nothing but a bell, a stone, or a breath.

fill *The Grey Wanderer, from a conversation at the Dusty Page*

edspace4Largepesection The Thought Trade: Psionic Economics

In the bustling markets of Zakov's free ports and the ancient bazaars of Silkstrand, a new form of commerce has emerged that challenges traditional notions of value and exchange. The Thought Trade represents the economic system that has grown around psionic abilities, where mental services, experiences, and even raw consciousness itself have become commodities with measurable worth.

edspace3largepesubsection Mental Labor Markets

Just as physical labor has wages and specialized skills, psionic abilities have created entirely new categories of mental labor that command premium prices across all social strata:

sectionMemory Merchants Telepaths who specialize in memory storage and retrieval have become invaluable to merchants, scholars, and nobles who need to preserve sensitive information without physical records. The going rate for one hour of secure memory storage is equivalent to a skilled craftsman's daily wage, but the risk premium for storing particularly dangerous or controversial memories can increase the price tenfold.

Market Integration: In cities like Ecktoria and Thepyrgos, Memory Guilds have established standardized contracts that specify the exact nature of memories to be stored, the duration of storage, and the conditions under which memories can be retrieved. Breaking a memory storage contract is considered a serious offense, often resulting in both legal penalties and social ostracism that can last for generations.

sectionCalculation Circles Psions with enhanced mathematical abilities have formed Calculation Circles that serve as living computers for complex engineering, navigation, and financial projects. These psions can perform calculations that would take traditional mathematicians months in a matter of hours, but the mental strain often requires significant recovery time.

Economic Impact: The rise of Calculation Circles has dramatically reduced the time and cost of largescale projects, from Aeler bridge construction to naval navigation for the Amaranthine Sea fleets. However, it has also created a dependency on psionic labor that some traditional craftsmen view as a threat to their livelihoods.

sectionEmotional Architects Empathic manipulators who specialize in mood and atmosphere control have found employment in everything from political rallies to theatrical performances. Their ability to subtly influence crowd emotions has made them highly sought after by politicians, merchants, and entertainers.

Regulatory Response: Several citystates have begun implementing "Mood Licensing" requirements for Emotional Architects, particularly when their services are used in political or commercial

contexts. Violations can result in both financial penalties and temporary suspension of psionic practice licenses.

edspace3large**subsection Thought Currency Systems**

The most revolutionary aspect of the Thought Trade is the development of systems where mental experiences themselves function as currency:

sectionExperience Exchange In certain underground markets, particularly in Free Havens like Sable Key, psions can trade raw experiencesmemories of adventure, intense emotions, or unique sensationsas direct equivalents to coin. A memory of a dragon flight might be worth fifty silver pieces, while the experience of true love might be valued at several gold coins.

Market Dynamics: The value of experiences fluctuates based on rarity, intensity, and cultural significance. Memories of historical events, first contact with supernatural entities, or particularly intense emotional experiences command premium prices. However, the market is also subject to fraudfalse or artificially enhanced memories can be difficult to detect and have led to the development of specialized "Memory Authenticators."

sectionSkill Debt Psions can enter into "Skill Debt" arrangements where they agree to provide specific mental services over time in exchange for immediate payment or favors. This has created a complex system of mental credit and obligation that operates alongside traditional economic systems.

Contract Law: The legal frameworks around Skill Debt vary significantly between jurisdictions. In Aeler holds, such contracts are treated with the same seriousness as infrastructure agreements, with detailed terms and severe penalties for breach. In more chaotic environments like Free Havens, Skill Debt arrangements may be more informal but carry higher risks for both parties.

edspace3large**subsection Psionic Guilds and Economic Power**

The economic importance of psionic abilities has led to the formation of powerful guilds that control various aspects of the Thought Trade:

sectionThe Memory Merchants' Consortium Operating primarily in the major port cities, this guild controls the legitimate market for memory storage and retrieval services. They maintain strict quality standards, detailed recordkeeping systems, and significant political influence in cities where information security is paramount.

Guild Benefits: Members receive access to secure storage facilities, legal protection for their services, and networking opportunities with highvalue clients. However, they must also adhere to strict confidentiality agreements and contribute a percentage of their earnings to guild funds.

sectionThe Calculation Collective A loose network of mathematical psions who coordinate on largescale projects that require multiple specialists. They've developed standardized protocols for collaborative mental computation and maintain a reputation for accuracy that commands premium rates.

Collective Structure: Unlike traditional guilds, the Calculation Collective operates more like a cooperative, with members sharing both risks and rewards. This structure has proven particularly effective for projects that require sustained mental effort from multiple participants.

edspace3large**subsection Economic Integration with Other Modules**

The Thought Trade creates natural connections with other aspects of the Fate's Edge economy:

sectionCaravan Integration Psionic couriers who can carry information mentally rather than physically have revolutionized longdistance communication. A telepath can carry the equivalent of

an entire library across dangerous terrain without risk of physical loss, but the mental strain limits the duration and frequency of such services.

Market Impact: This has created new trade routes and commercial relationships, as merchants can now conduct business across vast distances with unprecedented speed and security. However, it has also made psionic couriers targets for kidnapping and exploitation.

Political Intrigue Connections The ability to read minds and influence emotions has made psions both valuable assets and dangerous threats in political contexts. Political factions invest heavily in psionic protection (mental shielding) while also seeking to recruit or compromise opposing psions.

Diplomatic Protocol: Many courts have established formal protocols for psionic interactions, including designated "neutral mind spaces" where telepaths can operate without advantage to either side, and strict rules about when and how mental abilities can be used in negotiations.

Black Banner Applications Military organizations have integrated psionic units into their command structures, creating new tactical possibilities and logistical challenges. Psionic reconnaissance, communication, and psychological warfare capabilities have become essential elements of modern military strategy.

Military Economics: The cost of training and maintaining psionic military units is extremely high, but the strategic advantages often justify the investment. This has created a new category of military expenditure and influenced the balance of power between different factions.

edspace3largebesection Social and Cultural Implications

The Thought Trade has created new social dynamics and cultural practices:

The Gentry of the Mind A new social class has emerged consisting of wealthy individuals who have purchased extensive mental experiences, creating what some call "experiential aristocracy." These individuals often have more diverse and intense life experiences than those who rely solely on physical adventures or traditional education.

Social Tension: This has created friction with traditional nobility and wealthy merchants who view mental experiences as somehow less authentic than physical achievements. However, the practical advantages of extensive mental training and experience have made this tension less significant in practical terms.

The Privacy Divide Society has split between those who have access to mental privacy protection (through antipsionic training, magical wards, or technological means) and those who do not. This has created new forms of social stratification and economic inequality.

Market Response: Various industries have emerged to serve the privacy protection market, from specialized craftsmen who create antitelepathic jewelry to legal specialists who navigate the complex regulations around mental privacy rights.

The Thought Trade represents one of the most significant economic innovations in the Fate's Edge setting, demonstrating how psionic abilities can create entirely new categories of value and exchange while also generating new forms of social complexity and economic tension. For players, this system provides numerous opportunities for adventure, from protecting valuable mental cargo to navigating the complex legal and ethical issues that arise when consciousness itself becomes a commodity.

edspace4Largebesection The Great Silence: Psionic History

In the ancient past, before the rise of the Aeler holds and the establishment of the first Ykrul moots, the world experienced what scholars now call the Great Silencea period when psionic abilities across

all peoples were dramatically altered, suppressed, or transformed. This event, which lasted for what contemporary accounts describe as "three turnings of the great wheel" (approximately 200300 years), fundamentally changed how minds could touch minds across the world.

edspace3largebesubsection The Silence Event

The Great Silence did not eliminate psionic abilities entirely, but rather *compressed* them making mental powers more difficult to access, more costly to maintain, and more dangerous to use. During this period, what had once been natural gifts became rare talents that required intense training and came with significant risks.

Archaeological evidence from this period shows:

- tem Abandoned psionic academies across multiple cultures
- tem Sealed mental archives that were too dangerous to access
- tem Artifacts designed to *suppress* rather than enhance mental abilities
- tem Records of "mindstorms" where uncontrolled psionic energy caused physical and social chaos

edspace3largebesubsection Resonance Scars

Certain locations still bear the marks of the Great Silence, creating what scholars term "Resonance Scars" areas where psionic abilities function differently due to the lingering effects of that ancient suppression:

sectionThe Whispering Vaults (Aeler Holds) Deep within the oldest Aeler underways, certain chambers amplify Mental Strain by 2 segments but also grant +1 Effect to telepathic abilities. These spaces are both coveted and feared by Aeler psions, who must weigh the enhanced abilities against the increased mental cost.

sectionThe Empty Circle (Violet Steppe) A circular depression in the heart of Ykrul territory where no psionic abilities function at all. Ykrul oral history claims this was once the site of the "Last Conclave" where the greatest psions of their ancestors attempted to end the Silence but instead created a permanent null zone.

sectionThe Singing Stones (Lethai Valewood) Ancient standing stones that resonate with psionic energy, allowing for enhanced telepathic communication across vast distances but only when the stones themselves are "tuned" through proper context and ceremony.

edspace3largebesubsection Awakening Cycles

Since the end of the Great Silence, psionic abilities have slowly returned in what scholars recognize as distinct *Awakening Cycles*. These periods of increased psionic activity last 5075 years and are separated by longer periods of relative dormancy:

- tem[First Awakening (Current Cycle, 150 years ago - present)] Marked by the gradual return of basic telepathic and telekinetic abilities, particularly among younger generations.
- tem[Second Awakening (400325 years ago)] The period when precognition and biofeedback abilities first reappeared, leading to the establishment of many current psionic traditions.
- tem[Third Awakening (650575 years ago)] The mysterious period when astral projection and empathic manipulation returned, though records from this time are fragmentary.

Each Awakening Cycle brings not just the return of abilities, but the transformation of how those abilities function. Modern psions often find that their powers work differently from historical accounts, suggesting that each cycle fundamentally reshapes the nature of psionic interaction.

edspace3largebesection Cultural Memory and the Silence

Different cultures retain distinct memories of the Great Silence, each reflecting their unique relationship with mental abilities:

sectionAeler Records: The Accounting Aeler historical texts describe the Silence as a "misalignment of the mental ledgers" where the balance between mind and world became corrupted. They maintain that the current Awakening Cycle requires careful "mental accounting" to prevent another collapse.

sectionYkrul Oral Tradition: The Broken Paths Ykrul stories speak of the Silence as a time when "all routes between minds became blocked," making their Kon'rehbased approach to mental interaction impossible. They believe the current cycle represents a "reweaving" of those mental paths.

sectionLethai Codices: The Lost Context Lethai records suggest that during the Silence, the contextsaturated nature of their communication was temporarily severed, making their giftbased society impossible. They view the current Awakening as a "recontextualization" of mental abilities.

edspace3largebesection Modern Implications

The Great Silence has several ongoing effects on psionic practice in the present day:

tem **Generational Differences:** Older psions often have different abilities and limitations compared to those born during the current Awakening Cycle. tem **Cultural Tensions:** Different peoples have varying levels of comfort with psionic abilities based on their historical relationship with the Silence. tem **Scholarly Interest:** The study of Resonance Scars and Awakening Cycles has become a major field of research, with implications for understanding the fundamental nature of consciousness itself. tem **Prophetic Concerns:** Some scholars worry that the current Awakening Cycle may be building toward another Silence event, creating tension between those who want to preserve psionic abilities and those who fear their consequences.

The Great Silence serves as a reminder that psionic abilities are not staticthey are part of a dynamic system that has shaped and been shaped by the history of the world. For psionic characters, this creates both opportunities and dangers, as they may be part of a new transformation in how minds can touch minds across the Fate's Edge setting.

Design Philosophy: This bestiary and generator system provides flexible tools for creating diverse psionic encounters that maintain the unique flavor and mechanical identity of the Fate's Edge psionics system. Each entry emphasizes psychic abilities and consequences that integrate seamlessly with the core module.

edspace4Largebesection Psychic Bestiary

edspace3largebesection Minor Psychic Threats

sectionMind Tick **Tiny psychic parasite that feeds on stray thoughts**

tem **Tier:** Street tem **Attributes:** Body 1, Wits 3, Spirit 2 tem **Skills:** Stealth 2, Insight 1 tem **Psionics:** 1 (Telepathy) tem **Harm:** 1 (Mental Strain drain) tem **Special:** Can phase through small openings, detects psychic activity tem **Tactics:** Sneak attacks on sleeping or meditating targets

sectionEcho Wraith **Fragment of psychic energy from traumatic events**

tem **Tier:** Street tem **Attributes:** Body 1, Wits 2, Spirit 4 tem **Skills:** Stealth 2, Survival 1 tem **Psionics:** 2 (Telepathy, Clairvoyance) tem **Harm:** 2 (psychic assault) tem **Special:** Invisible in areas of psychic trauma, feeds on fear tem **Tactics:** Haunt locations, induce panic to strengthen itself

sectionThought Thief **Humanoid who has learned basic mental intrusion**

tem **Tier:** Street tem **Attributes:** Body 2, Wits 3, Spirit 2 tem **Skills:** Sway 2, Deception 2 tem **Psionics:** 2 (Telepathy, Empathic Manipulation) tem **Harm:** 1 (physical), 1 (mental) tem **Special:** Can steal surface memories, resistant to mental detection tem **Tactics:** Social manipulation, memory extraction

edspace3large**subsection Moderate Psychic Threats**

sectionPsiStalker **Professional hunter who uses telepathy to track targets**

tem **Tier:** Guild tem **Attributes:** Body 3, Wits 4, Spirit 3 tem **Skills:** Stealth 3, Survival 2, Insight 2 tem **Psionics:** 3 (Telepathy, Clairvoyance, Precognition) tem **Harm:** 2 (physical), 1 (mental) tem **Special:** Can track psychic signatures across miles, precognitive danger sense tem **Tactics:** Patient hunting, strike when target is vulnerable

sectionMentalist Cultist **Devotee of psionic philosophy who channels group power**

tem **Tier:** Guild tem **Attributes:** Body 2, Wits 3, Spirit 4 tem **Skills:** Command 2, Lore 2, Sway 2 tem **Psionics:** 3 (Telepathy, Empathic Manipulation, Mind Shield) tem **Harm:** 1 (physical), 2 (psychic assault) tem **Special:** Stronger when near other cultists, can share mental states tem **Tactics:** Crowd control, mental domination, group coordination

sectionAstral Predator **Creature that exists partially outside normal reality**

tem **Tier:** Guild tem **Attributes:** Body 2, Wits 3, Spirit 5 tem **Skills:** Stealth 3, Athletics 2 tem **Psionics:** 3 (Astral Projection, Telekinesis, Mind Shield) tem **Harm:** 2 (physical), 2 (psychic) tem **Special:** Can attack from astral form, immune to nonmagical weapons tem **Tactics:** Phase between realms, surprise attacks, ignore physical defenses

edspace3large**subsection Major Psychic Threats**

sectionCorrupted Psion **Former practitioner driven mad by power**

tem **Tier:** City tem **Attributes:** Body 3, Wits 4, Spirit 5 tem **Skills:** Melee 2, Insight 3, Survival 2 tem **Psionics:** 4 (All Arts at reduced effectiveness) tem **Harm:** 2 (physical), 3 (psychic assault) tem **Special:** Psychic Contamination full, causes SB on nearby psions, unstable powers tem **Tactics:** Erratic behavior, overwhelming psychic assault, selfdestructive power use

sectionMind Archon **Psionic entity that has transcended physical form**

tem **Tier:** City tem **Attributes:** Body 1, Wits 5, Spirit 6 tem **Skills:** Command 4, Lore 4 tem **Psionics:** 5 (Telepathy, Clairvoyance, Psychic Assault, Mind Shield, Precognition) tem **Harm:** 3 (psychic assault), can dominate minds tem **Special:** Exists primarily astrally, controls lesser psychic entities, vast mental reach tem **Tactics:** Mental domination, puppeteering minions, precognitive strategic advantage

sectionThe Hollow Crown **Psionic artifact that has gained malevolent consciousness**

tem **Tier:** Crown tem **Attributes:** Body 2, Wits 6, Spirit 6 tem **Skills:** Command 5, Sway 4
 tem **Psionics:** 5 (All Arts at full strength) tem **Harm:** 3 (psychic assault), can impose mental
 conditions tem **Special:** Influences all within psychic range, resistant to physical damage, grows
 stronger with use tem **Tactics:** Subtle manipulation, turning allies against each other, reality
 warping

edspace3largebesubsection **Legendary Psychic Threats**

sectionThe Fractured Sage **Ancient psion who has split consciousness across multiple bod-
 ies**

tem **Tier:** Synod tem **Attributes:** Body 4 (each fragment), Wits 6, Spirit 6 tem **Skills:** All
 skills 3+ tem **Psionics:** 5 (Each fragment specializes in different Arts) tem **Harm:** 3 (physical),
 3 (psychic), can regenerate from mental essence tem **Special:** Multiple simultaneous presences,
 shared consciousness, nearly immortal tem **Tactics:** Divide and conquer, overwhelming coordi-
 nation, impossible to truly defeat

edspace4Largebesection **Psionic Encounter Generators**

edspace3largebesubsection **Psychic Threat Generator (d100)**

	Roll	Threat Type	Description
0110	Minor Threat	1 creature	basic psionic abilities
1130	Minor Group	23 creatures	coordinated tactics
3150	Moderate Threat	1 creature	significant psionic abilities
5170	Moderate Group	Small group	with enhanced capabilities
7185	Major Threat	1 powerful creature	serious challenge
8695	Major Complex	Powerful threat	with minions/support
9600	Legendary Threat	Campaignlevel	psychic entity

edspace3largebesubsection **Psychic Environment Generator (d12)**

tem **Psychic Dead Zone:** No psionic abilities function, Mental Strain cannot be spent tem
Mental Resonance Chamber: All psionic use marks +1 Mental Resonance tem **Echo Corri-
 dor:** Past psionic events replay as illusions tem **Thought Storm:** Random telepathic messages
 bombard all minds tem **Astral Convergence:** Boundary between realms becomes thin tem
Memory Maze: Physical space shifts based on memories tem **Emotion Vortex:** Strong feel-
 ings become contagious and amplified tem **Precognition Field:** Brief glimpses of immediate
 future tem **Psychic Feedback Loop:** Psionic effects echo and multiply tem **Mind Mirror:**
 Thoughts become visible to others tem **Willpower Drain:** All mental actions cost +1 Mental
 Strain tem **Clairvoyant Nexus:** All hidden things become partially visible

edspace3largebesubsection **Psionic Artifact Generator (d12)**

tem **Thought Recorder:** Captures and replays memories of users tem **Emotion Amplifier:**
 Intensifies feelings in area tem **Astral Compass:** Points toward nearest psychic signature tem
Memory Crystal: Stores vast amounts of information psionically tem **Precognition Shard:**

Grants brief future visions but marks Echo Traces tem **Mind Shield Generator:** Creates area of psychic protection tem **Telepathy Amplifier:** Extends range and power of mental communication tem **Psychic Battery:** Stores Mental Strain for later use tem **Reality Anchor:** Prevents astral projection and psychic phaseshifting tem **Contamination Core:** Concentrates psychic corruption effects tem **Resonance Tuner:** Allows multiple psions to share Mental Resonance benefits tem **Null Stone:** Temporarily suppresses all psionic abilities in area

edspace3largebesection **Psychic Complication Generator (d12)**

tem **Tracking Signature:** Your psychic use leaves detectable traces tem **Mental Parasite:** Foreign consciousness shares your mind tem **Power Instability:** Psionic abilities trigger randomly under stress tem **Empathic Overflow:** You constantly feel others' emotions tem **Temporal Echo:** You occasionally glimpse possible futures tem **Psychic Addiction:** You crave psionic use, suffer penalties without it tem **Mental Scars:** Past trauma affects current psionic control tem **Resonance Sensitivity:** You're overwhelmed by other psions' activities tem **Astral Bleed:** Your physical and astral forms don't align properly tem **Memory Fragmentation:** Psionic use causes gaps in your memories tem **Emotional Contagion:** Your emotions strongly affect those nearby tem **Future Fixation:** Precognition makes you feel trapped in destiny

edspace3largebesection **Psionic Patron Generator (d8)**

tem **The Silent Order:** Ancient psionic brotherhood seeking balance tem **The Mind Merchants:** Trade in psychic services and information tem **The Astral Explorers:** Seek knowledge beyond physical reality tem **The Thought Police:** Enforce laws regarding mental privacy tem **The Emotion Artists:** Manipulate feelings as creative expression tem **The Precognition Traders:** Profit from glimpses of the future tem **The Memory Keepers:** Preserve and protect important knowledge tem **The Fractured Collective:** Hivemind seeking to expand consciousness

edspace3largebesection **Psionic Organization Generator (d8)**

tem **The Quiet Schools:** Educational institutions for psionic development tem **The Mind Merchants Guild:** Commercial organization trading psychic services tem **The Silent Hunters:** Professional trackers using telepathy tem **The Astral Guard:** Protectors who fight interdimensional threats tem **The Thought Police:** Law enforcement specializing in mental crimes tem **The Emotion Theaters:** Performance groups using empathic manipulation tem **The Future Traders:** Economic consortium profiting from precognition tem **The Memory Libraries:** Archives preserving knowledge psionically

edspace4Largebesection **Psionic Encounter Building**

edspace3largebesection **Single Threat Encounter**

tem Roll Psychic Threat Generator tem Roll Psychic Environment Generator for location modifier tem Roll 1d4 for additional complications (max 2) tem Roll 1d6 for beneficial environmental effects (12 = none, 34 = minor, 56 = significant)

edspace3largebesection Organization Encounter

tem Roll Psychic Organization Generator tem Roll 2d4 for number of members (23 = patrol, 45 = squad, 68 = strike team) tem Roll 1d3 for leader type (standard member, enhanced member, psionic specialist) tem Roll Psychic Environment Generator for operational theater tem Roll 1d4 for organizational goal (patrol, capture, eliminate, retrieve)

edspace3largebesection Artifact Encounter

tem Roll Psionic Artifact Generator tem Determine artifact's current state (14 = dormant, 58 = active, 912 = malevolent) tem Roll 1d6 for artifact's guardian (12 = none, 34 = minor threat, 5 = moderate threat, 6 = major threat) tem Roll Psychic Environment Generator for artifact's location tem Roll 1d4 for artifact's effect on users (1 = beneficial, 2 = neutral, 3 = harmful, 4 = transformative)

edspace4Largebesection Psionic Campaign Threads

edspace3largebesection The Resonance War

Two psionic organizations are escalating their conflict

tem **Minor Threats:** 35 encounters with organization members tem **Moderate Threats:** 23 encounters with specialists tem **Major Threat:** 1 encounter with organization leadership tem **Campaign Timer :** [8] tracks escalating conflict tem **Stakes:** Control of psionic resources, civilian safety, political influence

edspace3largebesection The Astral Breach

A rift between realms is growing larger

tem **Minor Threats:** 46 encounters with astral creatures tem **Moderate Threats:** 23 encounters with reality distortions tem **Major Threat:** 1 encounter with entity trying to cross over tem **Campaign Timer :** [6] tracks breach expansion tem **Stakes:** Reality stability, psionic safety, dimensional balance

edspace3largebesection The Memory Plague

A psychic disease is spreading through telepathic contact

tem **Minor Threats:** 35 encounters with infected individuals tem **Moderate Threats:** 23 encounters with disease vectors tem **Major Threat:** 1 encounter with plague origin/source tem **Campaign Timer :** [6] tracks disease spread tem **Stakes:** Mental health, social stability, psionic community survival

edspace3largebesection The Precognition Paradox

Future visions are becoming contradictory and dangerous

tem **Minor Threats:** 24 encounters with timedisplaced effects tem **Moderate Threats:** 23 encounters with fate manipulation tem **Major Threat:** 1 encounter with entity controlling temporal flow tem **Campaign Timer :** [8] tracks timeline instability tem **Stakes:** Free will, destiny, causality itself

edspace4Large**Psionic Adventure Seeds**

edspace3large**"The Silent Auction"**

A black market auction for psionic artifacts and services

tem **Hook:** PCs need rare component/service only available at auction tem **Location:** Secret venue with psychic security tem **Complications:** Multiple bidders, artifact activation, betrayal tem **Threats:** Corrupted psions, psychic predators, law enforcement tem **Reward:** Unique artifact, valuable information, powerful contact

edspace3large**"The Mind Prison Break"**

Dangerous psychic criminals are escaping from specialized facility

tem **Hook:** PCs hired to recapture escapees or prevent breakout tem **Location:** Highsecurity psionic prison with mental wards tem **Complications:** Guards compromised, reality distortion, public panic tem **Threats:** Escaped prisoners, facility malfunction, competing interests tem **Reward:** Substantial payment, criminal network disruption, public safety

edspace3large**"The Astral Investigation"**

Mysterious events require investigation in nonphysical realms

tem **Hook:** Physical world problem with astral root cause tem **Location:** Various planes of existence, psychic landscapes tem **Complications:** Different rules, time distortion, identity confusion tem **Threats:** Astral predators, trapped souls, reality anchors tem **Reward:** Unique knowledge, interdimensional contacts, reality stability

edspace3large**"The Emotion Plague"**

Contagious emotional state is spreading through population

tem **Hook:** PCs immune or need to stop spread for personal reasons tem **Location:** Urban environment with high population density tem **Complications:** Mass hysteria, social breakdown, economic impact tem **Threats:** Empathic manipulators, infected crowds, authority response tem **Reward:** Social influence, economic opportunities, emotional mastery

edspace4Large**Conclusion**

This bestiary and generator system provides flexible tools for creating diverse psionic encounters that maintain the unique flavor and mechanical identity of the Fate's Edge psionics system while offering GMs quick, customizable options for campaign play. The integration of consequence tracks, SB generation, and psionicspecific mechanics ensures that every encounter reinforces the core themes of mental discipline and its inherent risks.

Use these generators to populate your campaigns with memorable psychic threats, create dynamic environments that challenge psionic characters in unique ways, and develop ongoing story threads that explore the deeper implications of mental power in your game world.

Remember that the true strength of psionics lies not just in its mechanical benefits, but in the narrative possibilities it creates. Every psychic encounter should ask questions about the nature of consciousness, the responsibility of power, and the thin line between mastery and madness.

Psionic Investigation Procedures

The unique capabilities of psionic characters have created new methodologies for investigation and detection that integrate seamlessly with Fate's Edge's existing investigative frameworks. These procedures transform how mysteries are solved while maintaining the core tension between information gathering and consequence management.

Mental Detective Work

Psionic investigators operate within the same framework as traditional investigators but with enhanced capabilities that come with their own risks and limitations. The key is that psionic abilities don't eliminate the need for traditional investigation skills; they amplify and complicate them.

Memory Reading and Reconstruction Telepaths can access witness memories, but this process is far from simple information extraction:

Memory Integrity Test: When reading a witness's memory, the psion must make a Wits + Psionics vs. DV 35 (based on memory clarity, emotional trauma, and time elapsed).

Success: Gain Clue +1 and can ask one specific question about the memory's context

Partial: Gain Clue +1 but the memory is fragmented or confused with other events

Miss: Create False Memory [4] the witness now "remembers" something that isn't true

Mental Strain Cost: Each memory reading costs 1 Mental Strain, plus additional Fatigue equal to the witness's Spirit attribute (representing their mental resistance).

Deception Detection Psionic abilities enhance but don't guarantee the detection of lies:

Surface Thoughts Scan: Wits + Psionics vs. DV 3 to read immediate emotional reactions during questioning.

Success: Identify general emotional state (truth, deception, fear, confusion)

Partial: Detect emotional inconsistency but cannot determine its source

Miss: GM may spend SB to create False Confidence the psion becomes convinced of truth when deception exists

Deep Intent Reading: Spirit + Psionics vs. DV 45 to probe underlying motivations and truthfulness.

Cost: 2 Mental Strain plus target's Presence (if willing) or Spirit (if resistant)

Risk: On miss, tick Psychic Backlash [4] the target's mental resistance creates lasting strain

Crime Scene Psionics

Certain psionic abilities can extract information from crime scenes, but this practice is heavily regulated in most jurisdictions:

Residual Impression Reading Very sensitive telepaths can sometimes read "echoes" left by intense emotional or traumatic events at crime scenes.

Procedure: Wits + Psionics vs. DV 46 (based on time elapsed, intensity of emotions, and environmental interference)

Success: Gain vivid impression of final moments, potentially identifying perpetrator or victim state

Partial: Fragmented impressions that require interpretation and may be misleading

Miss: GM spends SB to create Psychic Contamination [4] the psion absorbs traumatic elements that affect future investigations

Legal Implications: In most civilized areas, residual impression reading requires:

- tem Official authorization from investigative authorities
- tem Presence of legal witnesses during the procedure
- tem Documentation of all impressions in official records
- tem Potential Psychic Evidence [6]
- timer that tracks admissibility in court

psubsection Psionic Evidence and Legal Complications

The introduction of mental evidence has created significant legal and ethical challenges across different jurisdictions:

sectionThe Admissibility Problem Most legal systems struggle with how to treat information obtained through psionic means:

Aeler Courts: Require dual testimony both the psion's interpretation and traditional evidence must support conclusions. Mental evidence alone is inadmissible.

Lethai Moots: Accept mental evidence when proper context witnesses can verify the psion's reading, but require extensive documentation of the context keys used.

Ykrul Bowl Proceedings: Mental evidence is acceptable if obtained without deception and with the subject's implied consent (no explicit refusal).

Free Haven Practice: Generally more permissive but require the psion to testify about their methods and potential for error.

sectionChain of Custody for Mental Evidence Just as physical evidence requires careful handling, mental evidence must maintain "psychic chain of custody":

- tem **Initial Reading:** Documented with time, location, and witness presence
- tem **Storage:** Mental impressions must be either immediately recorded or maintained in the psion's memory with regular verification
- tem **Transfer:** If transferring evidence to another psion, both must witness the transfer and document any changes
- tem **Presentation:** In court, the psion must recreate the evidence from memory, with potential for Mental Strain costs

psubsection Investigation Integration with Other Modules

Psionic investigation procedures naturally connect with other Fate's Edge systems:

sectionPolitical Intrigue Integration In political investigations, psionic abilities create both opportunities and risks:

- tem Reading political opponents' true intentions
- tem Detecting treason or hidden loyalties
- tem Risk of political retaliation if discovered
- tem Potential for creating false evidence through Psychic Manipulation [4]
- timers

sectionHorror Campaigns Enhancement Psionic investigation in horror settings amplifies both discovery and danger:

- tem Reading the memories of victims or witnesses increases Dread Timer segments
- tem Encountering alien or corrupted minds may cause Mental Corruption [4]
- tem Precognition abilities may reveal horrific truths that increase Reality Fracture Timer

sectionCaravan and Trade Investigation Psionic abilities are invaluable for detecting smuggling, fraud, and commercial espionage:

- tem Reading merchants' true intentions during negotiations
- tem Detecting hidden cargo or false manifests
- tem Risk of Merchant Guild retaliation for unauthorized mental intrusion
- tem Potential for creating Business Intelligence [6] assets through mental reconnaissance

edspace3largebesection Professional Psionic Investigators

Specialized investigators have emerged who focus primarily on psionic methods:

sectionThe Memory Advocates (Guild) Operating primarily in legal systems that accept mental evidence, these investigators combine traditional detective work with psionic enhancement:

tem **Services:** Witness memory recovery, deception detection, residual impression reading
 tem **Limitations:** Require legal authorization, maintain extensive documentation, face professional liability for false evidence tem **Costs:** 25 times normal investigation fees plus potential legal complications insurance

sectionThe Silent Seekers (Freelance) Independent investigators who operate in jurisdictions with less regulation:

tem **Services:** Covert mental investigation, missing person location through memory tracing, corporate espionage detection tem **Risks:** Legal vulnerability, potential for Mental Burnout [6] from overuse, reputationbased economy tem **Network:** Maintain informal connections with law enforcement who use their services unofficially

These investigation procedures ensure that psionic characters remain meaningfully engaged in investigative scenarios while preserving the core tension and complexity that makes Fate's Edge investigations challenging and interesting. The integration maintains mechanical balance by ensuring that psionic advantages come with proportional costs, risks, and complications that create ongoing story opportunities rather than simple problemsolving.

edspace4Largebesection Racial Psionic Integration

The development of psionic abilities has created unique relationships between different peoples and mental powers, with each culture's existing strengths and limitations shaping how they approach and utilize these extraordinary capabilities.

edspace3largebesection Aeler: The Deep Accountants

The Aeler's existing focus on precise measurement and resource management has profoundly influenced how they develop and utilize psionic abilities. For the Aeler, psionics represent another form of infrastructure that must be carefully maintained and accounted for.

sectionBreath Accounting and Mental Strain Aeler psions experience their mental strain through the same breathdebt system that governs all underground activity:

tem Each psionic use costs "breaths" that must be repaid through rest and proper ventilation
 tem Underground environments increase Mental Strain costs by 1 segment due to thin air
 tem Aeler holds maintain "breath banks" communal rest chambers where psions can recover mental energy

Deep Accounting Integration: Aeler psions must maintain detailed ledgers of their mental activities, recording:

tem Mental Strain expenditure and recovery times tem Effectiveness of different abilities in various environments tem Costbenefit analysis of psionic vs. traditional approaches

sectionInfrastructure Psionics Aeler psions often specialize in abilities that enhance their society's infrastructure:

tem **Structural Sense:** Enhanced ability to perceive stress points and weak spots in buildings and constructions tem **Vent Reading:** Advanced understanding of air flow patterns that enhances telepathic range underground tem **Resonance Mapping:** Ability to sense the "health" of infrastructure systems through mental connection

Cultural Integration: Aeler psions are highly valued for maintaining underground settlements, but their "breath debt" makes them dependent on community support. This creates a symbiotic relationship where psions provide essential services while requiring significant community investment in their maintenance.

edspace3largebesubsection Lethai: The Context Keepers

The Lethai's contextsaturated communication system has created a unique approach to psionics where mental abilities are as dependent on social and environmental context as their spoken language.

sectionContextSaturated Telepathy Lethai psions must navigate the same contextsaturated communication as their nonpsionic kin:

tem Reading minds without proper "context keys" (place, season, relationship) produces garbled or misleading information tem Mental communication requires the same ritualized preparation as spoken communication tem Different mental "dialects" exist between Lethaial, Lethaiar, and Lethaithora communities

Mark Integration: Lethai psions often enhance their abilities through traditional Marks (tattoos, scars, resininlay) that serve as mental anchors:

tem Spider's Patience Mark grants enhanced concentration for telepathic eavesdropping tem Serpent's Breath Mark enhances ability to detect deception and hidden intentions tem StormShadow Mark allows for enhanced precognition during weather events

sectionGiftBased Psionic Development The Lethai's Gift division creates distinct psionic development paths:

tem **BodyGift Psions:** Enhanced physical psionic abilities (telekinesis, biofeedback) that align with physical excellence tem **MindGift Psions:** Enhanced mental abilities (precognition, telepathy) that complement mental acuity tem **BridgeBorn Psions:** Rare individuals who can combine both types but face social skepticism

Cultural Integration: Lethai psions serve as living archives and contextmediators, but their knowledge becomes "cursed" when removed from proper context. This creates a natural limitation that prevents them from becoming overpowered while maintaining their cultural significance.

edspace3largebesubsection Ykrul: The Weather Readers

The Ykrul's mastery of Kon'reh (sacred geometry) and their relationship with open spaces has shaped their approach to psionics around pattern recognition and tactical awareness rather than direct mental manipulation.

sectionKon'rehAugmented Precognition Ykrul psions don't see the future directlythey read the "flow/weight/exit" patterns of probability through their existing geometric understanding:

tem Precognition is tied to routefinding and tactical awareness rather than personal fortunetelling tem Mental visions appear as geometric patterns that must be interpreted through Kon'reh principles tem Group precognition is more effective than individual multiple psions can "map" probability spaces

Weather Integration: Ykrul psions have enhanced sensitivity to atmospheric conditions that affect their abilities:

- tem Storm conditions enhance telepathic range but increase Mental Strain costs
- tem Clear weather allows for more precise precognitive readings
- tem Wind patterns can carry or disrupt mental communications over long distances

sectionTactical Psionics Ykrul psions excel in abilities that support their nomadic, clanbased society:

- tem **Herd Sense:** Enhanced ability to perceive the emotional and physical state of groups
- tem **Route Reading:** Mental mapping that combines geographic knowledge with tactical awareness
- tem **Banner Communication:** Longdistance mental communication between clan members

Cultural Integration: Ykrul psions are invaluable scouts and tacticians, but their "sightings" must be interpreted through Kon'reh principles. This creates a collaborative relationship where psions provide raw data that clan leaders must interpret through their cultural wisdom system.

edspace3largebesubsection Vilakari: The Information Brokers

The Vilakari's expertise in information networks and their position as cultural intermediaries has led to the development of psionic abilities focused on information gathering and social manipulation.

sectionNetworked Telepathy Vilakari psions excel at surface thoughts and emotional currents in crowded spaces:

- tem Enhanced ability to read emotional undercurrents in marketplaces and social gatherings
- tem Difficulty with deep, private thoughts due to cultural emphasis on surface interactions
- tem Natural talent for detecting deception in commercial negotiations

ThoughtMarkets: Vilakari psions have developed "thoughtmarkets" where information is traded through mental contact:

- tem Information brokers who specialize in mental exchanges
- tem Standardized "thoughtprices" for different types of information
- tem Reputation systems based on the accuracy and usefulness of mental information

sectionCommercial Psionics Vilakari psions often specialize in abilities that enhance their informationbrokering activities:

- tem **Surface Reading:** Enhanced ability to read immediate thoughts and intentions in social situations
- tem **Memory Trading:** Ability to temporarily share specific memories for commercial transactions
- tem **Negotiation Sense:** Enhanced perception of the underlying dynamics in business dealings

Cultural Integration: Vilakari psions operate underground information networks, but their abilities make them vulnerable to mental "audits" by authorities. This creates a catandmouse dynamic where psions must constantly balance the value of their abilities against the risks of detection.

edspace3largebesubsection CrossCultural Psionic Development

The interaction between different racial approaches to psionics has created unique opportunities and conflicts:

sectionCultural Exchange Programs Some communities have established formal programs for crosscultural psionic training:

tem Aeler academies that teach Lethai context integration tem Lethai moots that explore Ykrul tactical applications tem Ykrul clan gatherings that learn Vilakari information networks tem Vilakari brokerages that adopt Aeler accounting precision

sectionHybrid Abilities Individuals of mixed heritage or extensive crosscultural training may develop unique hybrid abilities:

AelerLethai: Psions who combine precise mental accounting with contextsensitive communication **YkrulVilakari:** Psions who merge tactical precognition with information brokering skills **LethaiYkrul:** Psions who blend contextbased telepathy with geometric pattern recognition

Social Dynamics: Different cultures have varying levels of acceptance for psionic abilities, creating complex social landscapes where psions must navigate not just their mental abilities but also the cultural expectations and limitations of their communities. This integration ensures that psionic characters remain meaningfully connected to the setting's cultural diversity while providing unique mechanical and narrative opportunities that reflect their peoples' distinct worldviews and capabilities.